



BRIDGEBURNER

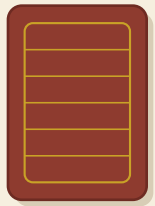


A two-player card game of building & sabotage

2 players · standard 52-card deck · ~15 minutes per round

SETUP

Shuffle the deck. Deal 7 cards to each player. Flip 3 cards face-up in the middle: this shared pool is the **River**. The rest becomes a face-down draw pile — and the draw pile is the **clock**. It is never reshuffled. When it runs out, the round ends.



DRAW PILE



THE RIVER (always 3 face-up cards)



YOUR HAND (7 cards)

HOW TO WIN

Build a **bridge**: a face-up row of **5 cards in ascending value** in front of you. Suits don't matter and gaps are fine — each card just has to beat the one before it. Aces are low.

Equal turns: if the first player finishes a bridge, the second player gets one last turn.

The clock: when the draw pile runs out, the round ends after that turn — the longer bridge wins.

Ties (both finished, or equal length): compare the top card, then the next card down. Play best of three.



A WINNING BRIDGE — EACH CARD HIGHER THAN THE LAST



FACE CARDS ARE MORTAR

A Jack or Queen at the end of your bridge is tough: burning it costs your rival their entire turn (2 actions) instead of 1. Nothing burns a King — but nothing builds past one either. Overreach with mortar too early and you'll have to Demolish to keep climbing.

ON YOUR TURN: SPEND 2 ACTIONS

Mix and match, or repeat the same action twice — whatever the cost allows.



DRAW 1 ACTION

Take the top card of the draw pile into your hand.



BUILD 2 ACTIONS

Play a card from your hand onto the right end of your bridge. It must be **higher** than your current rightmost card. Slow, deliberate work — a full build takes your whole turn, so your rival always gets a chance to answer.



BURN 1 ACTION*

Discard a hand card that matches the **color** (red/black) of your opponent's rightmost bridge card **and beats it**. Nothing burns a King. Their card is destroyed — and washes into the River, replacing its oldest card. *Mortar resists the flames: burning a Jack or Queen costs **both** actions.



FORD 1 ACTION

Discard any card from your hand, take any one of the 3 River cards, then refill the River from the draw pile. A known card beats a blind draw.



FLUSH 1 ACTION

Discard all 3 River cards and deal 3 fresh ones from the draw pile. Fish for what you need — but your rival sees the new cards, and the clock ticks 3.



DEMOLISH 1 ACTION

Remove the rightmost card of **your own** bridge to the discard pile. Sometimes you tear down a low card to rebuild a taller ascent.

ARSONIST'S ADVICE



- Every burn spent is a card not built — attack when it costs them more than it costs you.
- High cards are finishers first and torches second — a King spent on a 6 is a bridge you'll never complete.
- Watch the colors: cap your bridge with a card whose higher ranks in that color are already gone.
- The River remembers. Burned cards resurface there — don't hand your rival their card back.
- The pile is the clock. Every draw and ford brings the end nearer — a half-built bridge beats an empty one.
- Mortar buys time, not immunity. A face-card cap costs your rival a full turn to burn — build while they swing.

OPTIONAL HOUSE RULES — agree before dealing

Quick foundations: your first two bridge cards cost 1 action each instead of 2. Shorter rounds, bridges up from turn 2, more comebacks — but fewer burns.

Close torches: a burn card must be at most 2 ranks above the card it burns (a King only burns a Jack or Queen). Use it if your games turn into burn wars where nobody finishes a bridge.